

DATE: September 20, 2026

SUBJECT: Analysis of 2-Year Public Enrollment Trends and Federal Grant Allocation

Executive Summary

- Enrollment: First-time, full-time undergraduate enrollment at public two-year colleges changed by -16.65% between 2010 and 2015 in the retained panel.
- Grant allocation: The observed and simulated cross-state 90/10 ratios are 1.63 and 1.12, respectively. The simulated budget change in the retained sample is \$134.3 million.

Data & Methodology

The complete-case balanced panel contains 5,148 undergraduate institutions and 30,888 institution-year observations from unrevised IPEDS files. Institutions without all required eligible observations are excluded, so results describe only the retained sample.

2-Year Public College Enrollment Trends

Total first-time, full-time enrollment across public two-year colleges was 806,760 in 2010 and 672,435 in 2015, a change of -16.65% (Figure 1).

Current Federal Grant Distribution (2015–16)

Average federal grant aid per student was \$2,315.17 in New York and \$1,364.22 in Vermont (Figure 2). Across the 50 included states, the unweighted mean of state rates was \$1,880.22, the sample standard deviation was \$373.97, and the 90/10 ratio was 1.63 (Figure 3). Each state rate is total grants divided by total enrollment within that state.

Simulated Policy Impact

Under the specified institution-level formula, the observed and simulated standard deviations of state aid rates are \$373.97 and \$120.00, respectively. The corresponding highest-minus-lowest ranges are \$1,629.15 and \$711.37, and the 90/10 ratios are 1.63 and 1.12 (Figures 4 and 5). Simulated minus observed spending is \$134,258,227.65 in the retained sample.

Conclusion

The simulated budget difference is \$134.3 million; positive values indicate additional spending and negative values indicate lower spending. Figure 6 shows states with increases and decreases in simulated grant totals. These calculations describe allocation and dispersion, not causal effects or a welfare assessment.

Appendix: Figures

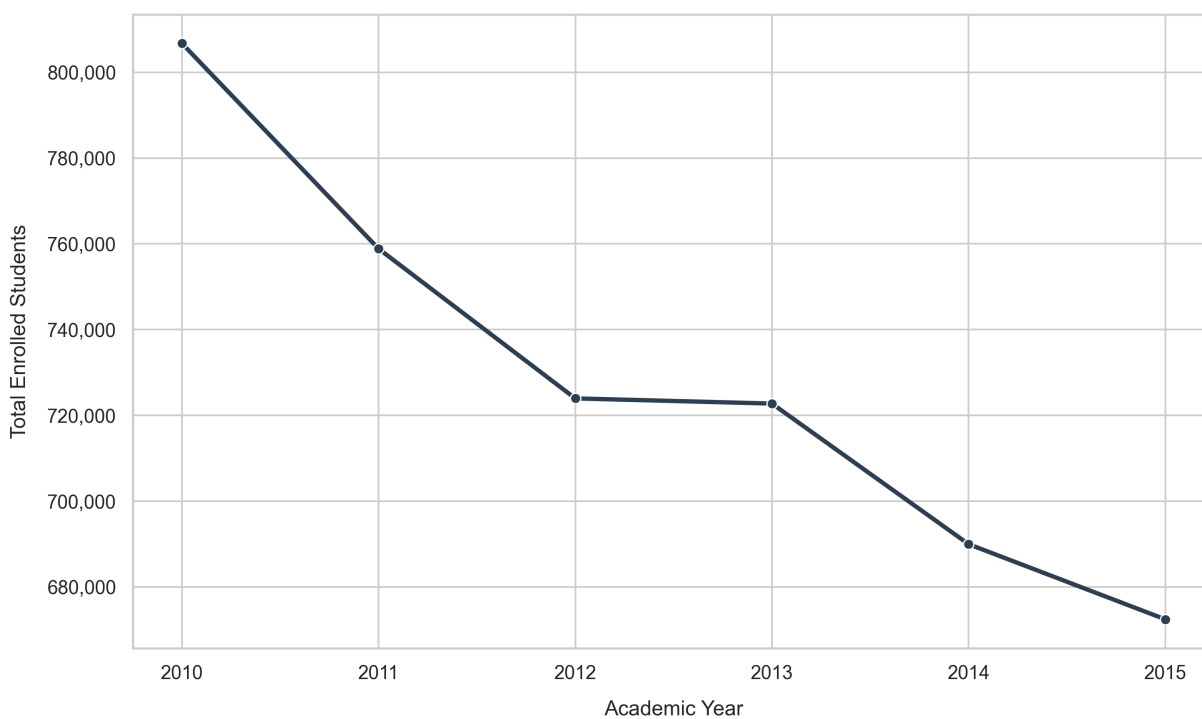


Figure 1: Total First-Time, Full-Time Undergraduate Enrollment at Public 2-Year Colleges (2010–2015)

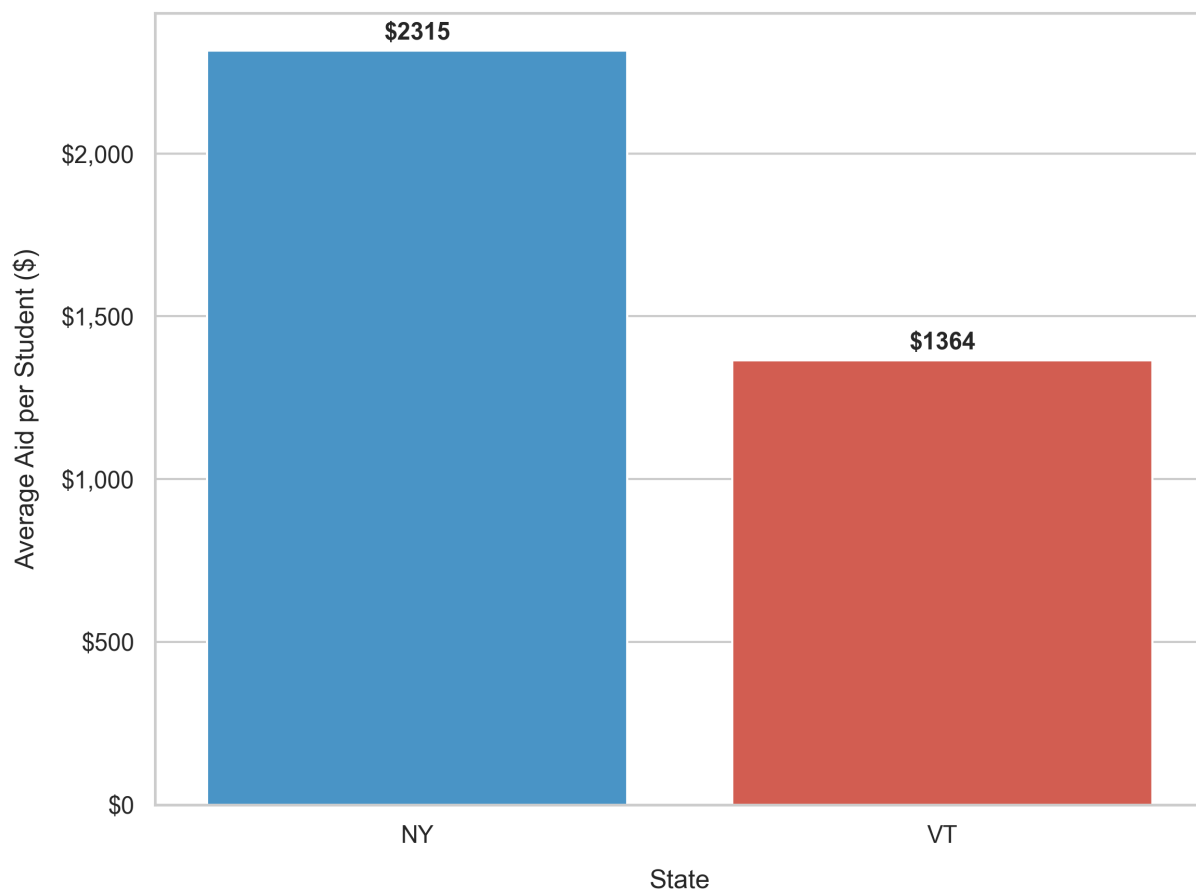


Figure 2: Average Federal Grant Aid per Student: New York vs. Vermont (2015–16)

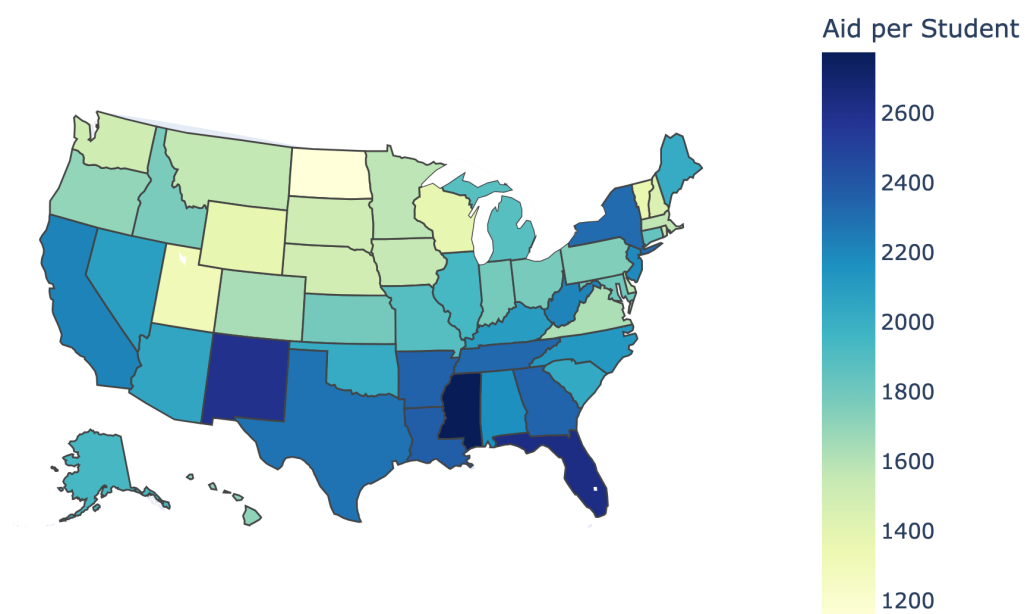


Figure 3: Average Federal Grant Aid per Student by State (2015–16)

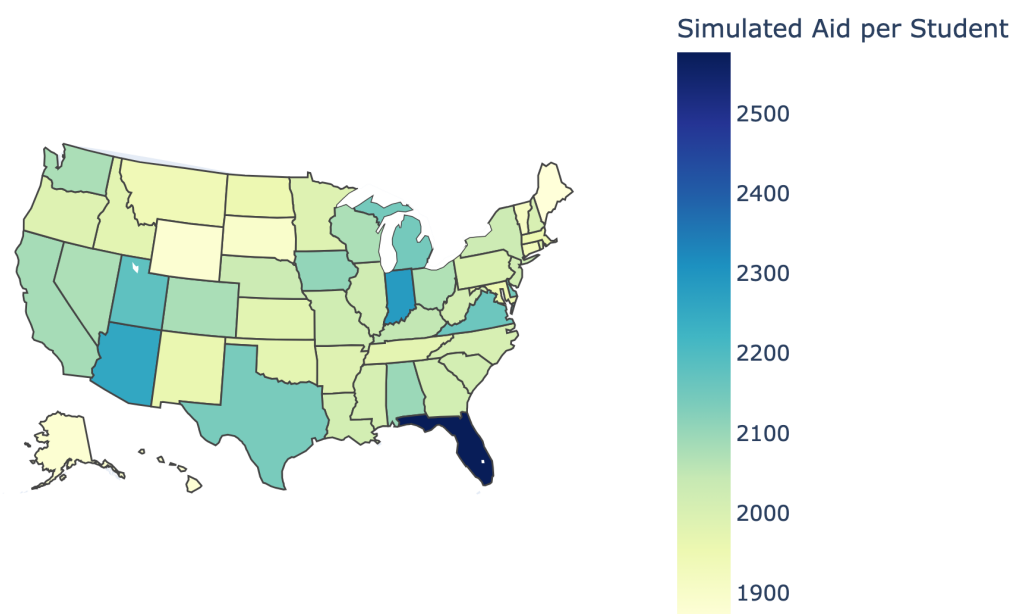


Figure 4: Simulated Federal Grant Aid per Student by State

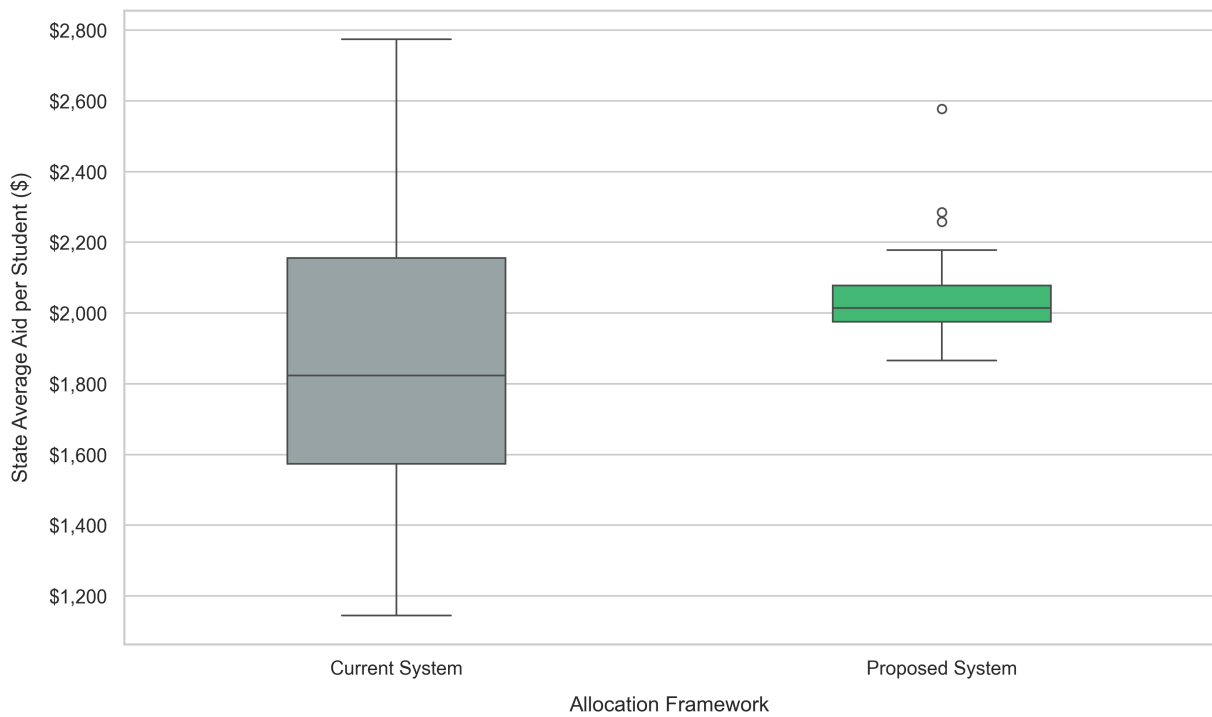


Figure 5: Distribution of State Average Per-Student Aid: Observed and Simulated (2015–16)

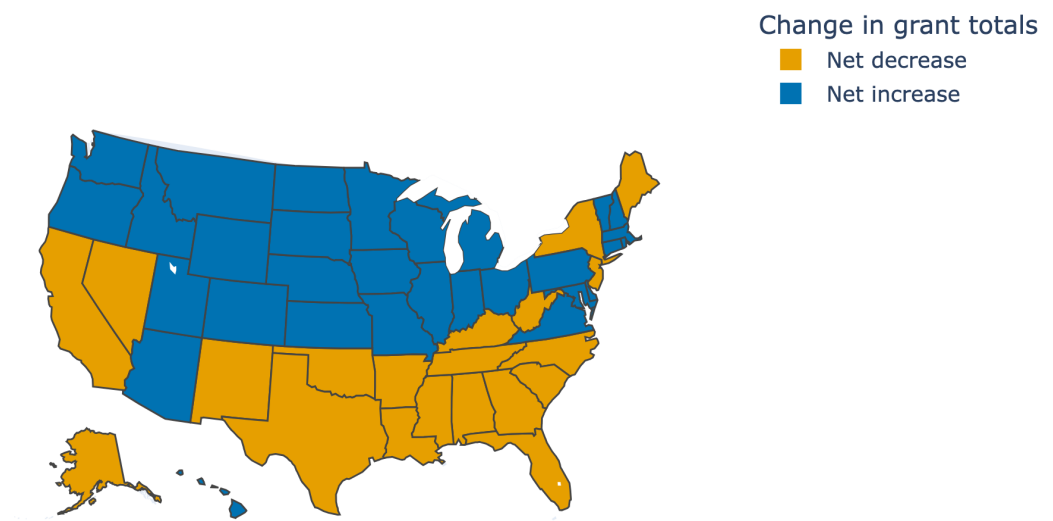


Figure 6: States with Increases and Decreases in Simulated Grant Totals